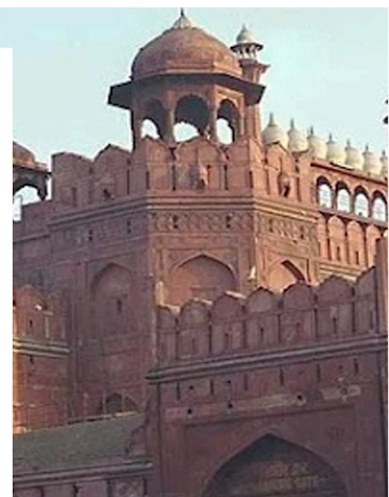
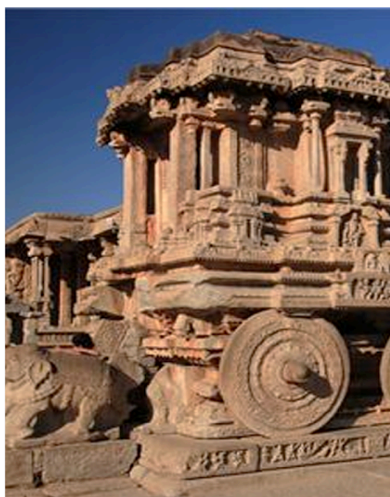


General Knowledge

Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

Islamic Invasion



Islamic Invasion



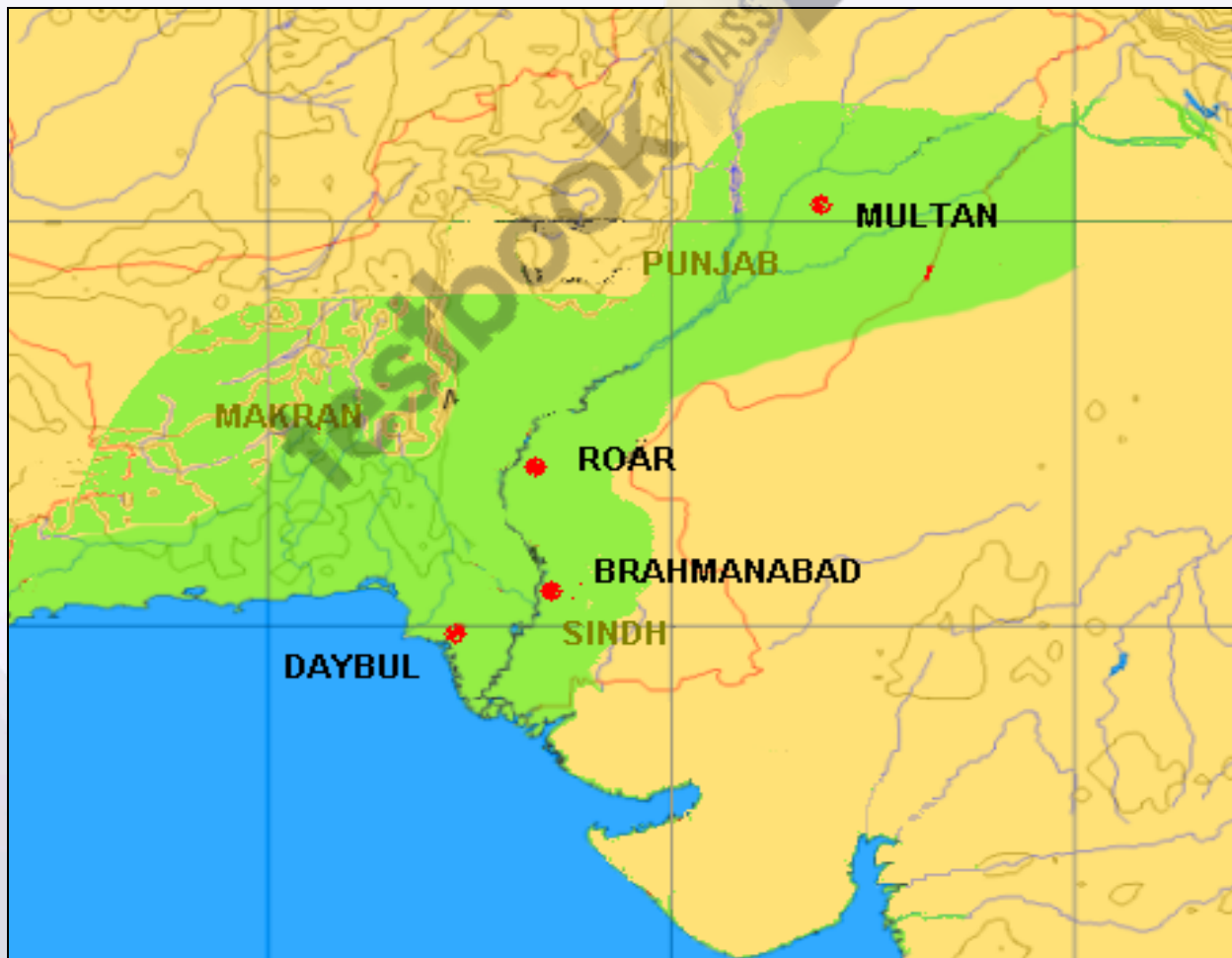
The period from **1000 to 1200 A.D.** saw rapid changes both in West and Central and in North India. **It was these developments that led to the incursion of the Turks into Northern India** towards the end of the period.

Muhammad Bin Qasim, the Conqueror, and his Expeditions

- **Qasim was the nephew of Hajjaj, the governor of Iraq (Umayyad Caliphate)**
- Being an able commander he was appointed by his uncle as the head of the frontier district of Makran.
- **He was given a mission of conquest in the direction of Sindh.**
- As a general, **Qasim reached the delta of the Indus besieging the city of Debal by land**; the additional war materials reached him by sea.
- **Debal was a great city on the mouth of the river Indus that was ruled by a lieutenant of King Dahar.**
- Qasim followed a **policy of tolerance towards the defeated population.**
- He allowed **religious freedom to both the Brahmanic and Buddhist people.**

- He was the first Muslim to have successfully **captured Hindu territories and initiate early Islamic India in 712 AD**
- The conquest of Sindh, in modern-day Pakistan, although costly, was a major gain for the Umayyad Caliphate
- Everywhere **taxes (*Mal*) and tribute (*kharaj*)** were settled and hostages were taken. This shows **he was not an invader but tried to establish stable rule.**
- The **Arabs attempted to invade India but they were defeated by Rawal Kalbhoja of Mewar**, north Indian Rajput king Nagabhata of the Gurjara-Pratihara Dynasty, and by the Indian Emperor Vikramaditya II of the Chalukya dynasty in the early 8th century.
- **After the failure of further expeditions on Kathiawar, the Arab rulers gave up the project of conquering any part of India.**

Extent and expansion of Umayyad rule under Muhammad bin Qasim in medieval India



Age of Conflict in West Asia

Background

- By the end of the ninth century, the **Abbasid Caliphate was in decline. Its place was taken by a series of states ruled by Islamized Turks.**
- **Meanwhile, the breakup of the Gurjara-Pratihara empire led to a phase of political uncertainty in North India** and the new phase of the struggle for domination.
- As a result, little attention was paid to the emergence of an aggressive, expansionist Turkish state on the North-Western border of India.

The Abbasid Caliphate: 750–1258

- **The Abbasids** had come to power espousing many popular causes particularly the claims of the Shias
- **Abbasid power was based on the military support of their Khurasani soldiers.**
- They asserted their authority by restoring stability and worked out various compromises with the groups who had opposed the Umayyads.
- They ruled as caliphs for most of the caliphate from their capital in Baghdad in modern-day Iraq, after having overthrown the Umayyad Caliphate in the **Abbasid Revolution of 750 CE**

The Ghaznavids

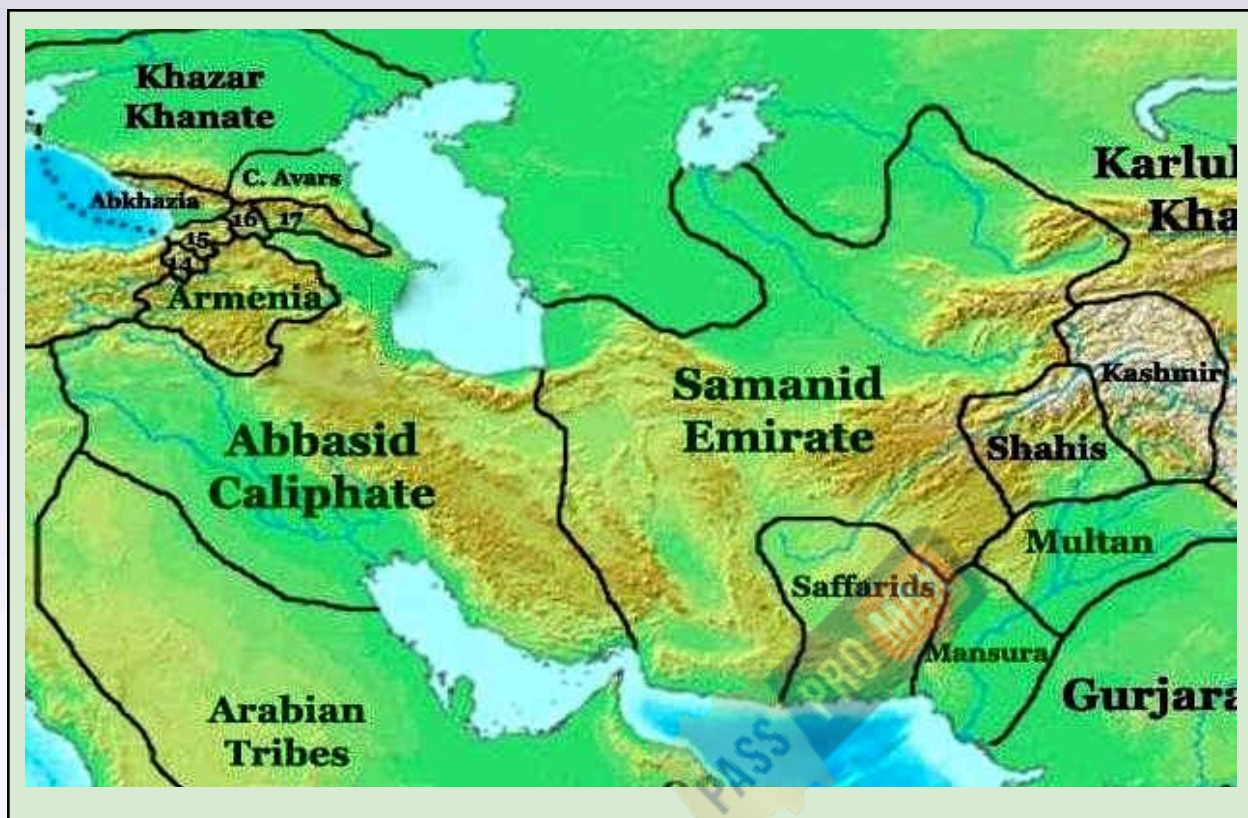
- The **Ghaznavid Dynasty** was founded after the Turk slaves reached higher posts, such as commanders-in-chief, in the Samanid court; they then took over the state of Khorasan
- The real founder of the **Ghaznavid Dynasty is, in fact, Sabuktigin.**
- His time can be considered important because **he was the beginner of India's conquest.**
- He **launched sixteen or seventeen invasions of India's territories.**
- At the time of Sultan Mahmud, the vast country of **India lacked a central government**, and local rulers with special titles controlled the power in their own regions throughout the country.

- One by one, those regions were conquered by Sultan Mahmud, including **Peshawar, Bahatia Multan, and so on.**



Information About the Samanid Empire

- It was an Iranian empire (819 to 999 A.D.)
- They were the **first Islamic Persian rulers.**
- The empire was centred in **Khorasan and Transoxiana.**
- **Four brothers—Nuh, Ahmad, Yahya, and Ilyas—founded the Samanid state.**
- Rulers of the Samanid Empire **set up a local dynasty within the Abbasid Empire.**
- The Samanids eventually ruled an area from central Iran to India.
- Their empire didn't last long and waned **in the early 10th century due to internal divisions.**



The Rajput states

Location the Gurjara-Pratiharas, Rashtrakutas, Palas, Cholas, and Chahamanas (Chauhans). (7th to 12th century)

- With the breakup of the Pratihara empire, a number of Rajput states came into existence in North India.
- The most important of these were the **Gadhavalas of Kanauj**, **The Paramaras of Malwa**, and **the Chauhans of Ajmer**.
- The Chauhans who had established themselves at Ajmer were gradually extending their empire towards Gujrat, as well as towards Delhi and Punjab.



Contemporary kingdoms during 800 1200 A.D. in North India:

Kingdoms	Capital/Regions
Chandellas	• Baghelkhand (Northeastern M.P and a small region of U.P.) • Capital: Haladip
Palas	• East India
Pratiharas	• Bundelkhand (Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh) • Capital: Kannauj
Chauhans	• Rajasthan: Mewar and Marwar
Tomars	• Delhi and Punjab region • Capital: Delhi

Contemporary kingdoms during 800 1200 A.D. in South India

Kingdoms	Capital/Region
Rashtrakutas	• From Narmada to Krishna rivers • Capital: Malkhed
Chola	• South India: Tamilnadu, Andhra Pradesh, and parts of Karnataka • Capital: Tanjore

Information about contemporary kingdoms :

Pratiharas (8th Century to 11th century):

- They were ruling around the Bundelkhand region.
- **Bhoja was the ambitious king between 806-836 AD.** He defeated Rashtrakutas to acquire Kannauj in 851 AD.

- Pratiharas later split into various kingdoms again.
- **In the Pratihara kingdom, Arabs of the Sindh region were considered *mlechchhas*** as they were trying to attack Indian subcontinent rulers.
- **Historical pieces of evidence prove that Pratiharas defeated Arabs in many wars.**

Palas (8th century to 12th century):

- **King Gopala was the founder.** They ruled over Bengal and Bihar for 400 years.
- Palas had a very strong army. They used to trade with South-East Asia.

Rashtrakutas(8th century to 10th century):

- *Rashtrakutas* were the feudatories of *Chalukyas*. They rebelled to form their kingdom.
- They were ruling around Nashik. The capital was *Malkhed*.
- **Amoghavarsha was the ambitious king who belonged to Rashtrakutas.**

Foreign Travellers:

Sulaiman:

- He was an **Arab merchant** who visited during the reign of the **Pala Empire in 851 AD.**
- He was in the court of **Amoghavarsha.**
- He wrote an account based on his voyages. He had a majority of **descriptions about the Pala empire and his administration.** Beyond it, there are some **glimpses of Mihir Bhoja, a king who belonged to the Parmar dynasty.**
- In his account, he had written about **Mihir Bhoja king as 'Juhr'.** It's an Arabic word meaning powerful king of Gujrat.
- Mihira Bhoja was a bitter enemy of the Arab invaders who, **according to Sulaiman, maintained a large army and had a fine cavalry.**

Alberuni(973-1048 AD):

- **Mehmud Gazni sent him to write a book on the Indian subcontinent.**
- **'Tahqiq-i-Hind' was the name of the book in which** he described the social, political, religious, and economic conditions of then India.

Administration of Rajput kingdoms

- They (Rajput rulers) often **shared power with their Samantas** as well as with associations of peasants, traders, and Brahmanas
- In each of these states, resources were obtained from the producers – that is, peasants, cattle keepers, and artisans – who were often persuaded or compelled to surrender part of what they produced.
- The functionaries for **collecting revenue were generally recruited from influential families, and positions were often hereditary.**
- This was true about the army as well. In many cases, close **relatives of the king held these positions.**
- Kings often **rewarded Brahmanas with grants of land. These were recorded on copper plates,** which were given to those who received the land.

Military administration

- For centuries, rulers belonging to the Gurjara-Pratihara, Rashtrakuta, and Pala dynasties **fought for control over Kanauj.** Because there were three “parties” in this long-drawn conflict, historians often describe it as the **“tripartite struggle”.**
- These rulers attacked one another’s kingdoms, they often **chose to target temples,** which **were sometimes extremely rich.**

Features of the Rajput society:

- **The basis of the Rajput society was the Clan**
- Attachment to the land, family, and honour was a characteristic of the Rajputs.
- **The sense of brotherhood and egalitarianism which prevailed among Rajputs was a major advantage for them.**
- However, their basic weakness was their tendency to form exclusive groups, each claiming superiority over others. **They were not prepared to extend their brotherhood to non-Rajputs.**
- **Most of the Rajput rulers of the time were champions of Hinduism** though some of them also patronized Jains.

Cultural Significance

- The period after the eighth century, and particularly **between the tenth and twelfth centuries** may be regarded as marking a climax in temple building activity in North India.
- **The style of temple construction which came into prominence was called the Nagara.**
- Though found almost all over India, the main centres of construction in this style were in North India and the Deccan.
- **Its main characteristic feature was the tall curved spiral roof over the chief deity room called the Garbgriha or the deul.**
- The main room was generally a square, though projections could be made from each of its sides.
- Examples - **Khajuraho in Madhya Pradesh, The Parsvanatha temple - and the Kandaraya Mahadeo temple at Khajuraho.**
- Rajputs also patronized arts and letters.
- **Vastupala, the famous minister of the Chalukyan ruler Bhima, was a writer and patron of scholars and the builder of the beautiful Jain temple at Mt. Abu.**
- **Ujjain and Dhara, the capitals of the Paramara ruler, were other famous centres for Sanskrit learning.**
- Many works were **written in Apabhramsha and Prakrit which represented the language of the region.**
- The Jain scholars made significant contributions in this direction, the most famous among them being **Hemchandra who wrote both in Sanskrit and Apabhramsha.**



Parsvanatha Temple - Khajuraho temple complex



Jain Temple at Mount Abu

The Turkish Conquest of North India

Background

- After the Ghaznavid conquest of Punjab, two distinct patterns of relations between the Muslims and the Hindus were at work -



1. The rulers of the Rajput states put up a **stout resistance against the raids of successors of Ghaznavids and won victories against the Turks on a number of occasions.**
2. At the second level, Muslims were allowed to strengthen and augment the trade of India with the west and central Asia. Thus, the **process of interaction between Islam and Hindu religion and society was started.**



- Towards the middle of the **12th century another group of Turkish tribesmen, who were partly Buddhist and partly Paragon, shattered the power of Seljuk Turks.** In the vacuum, two powers rose to power, the **Khwarizmi Empire based in Iran and the Ghurid Empire based in Ghur in northwest Afghanistan.**



- The power of the Khwarizmi empire checked the expansion of the Ghurids in a westward direction. So Ghurids started their expansion towards India.



- **In 1173, Shahabuddin Muhammad also known as Muizzuddin bin Sam (Muhammad Ghuri) ascended the throne of Ghazani.** Proceeding by the way of the **Gomal Pass**, he conquered Multan and Uchch.



- Meanwhile, the **Chauhans captured Delhi from the Tomars** around the middle of the century. This **expansion of Chauhans brought them into conflict with the Ghaznavid rulers of the area.**

Battle of Mahoba (1182)

- **The young ruler of Ajmer, Prithviraj, invaded the Bundelkhand area and defeated the Chandella rulers in the battle near Mahoba.**
- **It was in this battle the famous brothers Alha and Udal died fighting to save Mahoba.**

The Battle of Tarain (1191 and 1192)

- **Muhammad Ghuri captured Multan in 1175, and in 1178, unsuccessfully invaded the Chaulukya Kingdom in present-day Gujarat and northern Rajasthan.** Subsequently, the Ghurids defeated the Ghaznavids and conquered **Lahore in 1186.**
- **Ghurids sent their envoy to the court of Prithviraj and demanded to accept their suzerainty**
- **Prithviraj rejected the demands of the Ghurids.**
- **Then Ghurids decided to attack the Chauhan Kingdom.**
- **The battle between Prithviraj and Muizzuddin Muhammad (Muhammad Ghuri) ruler of the Gazni, was inevitable because Bhima 2, the ruler of Gujrat defeated Prithviraj in the battle, which forced Prithviraj to expand his territories towards Punjab.**
- **The conflict between Prithviraj and Muizzuddin Muhammad started over Bhatinda.**
- **In the battle which was fought at Tarain (1191), the Ghuri forces were completely routed.**
- **Again in 1192, the second battle of Tarain was fought between Prithviraj and Muizzuddin Muhammad, which is regarded as one of the turning points in Indian History.**
- **Prithviraj was defeated in this battle.**
- **The superior organization skill and speed of movements of the Turkish cavalry ultimately decided the issue.**
- **Prithviraj's son moved to Ranthambore and founded a new powerful Chauhan kingdom there.**
- **Thus Delhi area and eastern Rajasthan passed under Turkish rule.**

Information about Prithviraj Chauhan :

- He was a Chauhan ruler of Rajasthan.
- He belonged to the *Suryavanshi* family.
- His capital was Ajmer in Rajasthan.
- He controlled much of the present-day Rajasthan, Haryana, and Delhi; and some parts of Punjab, Madhya Pradesh, and Uttar Pradesh.
- **Chand Bardai:** A poet wrote an epic poem named 'Prithviraj Raso' in Brajbhasha.

Information about Muhammad Gazni (Muizzuddin Muhammad 971-1030 AD) :

- He was a Turkish ruler who founded his small kingdom in Afghanistan.
- His aspirations were big to capture Central Asia and not India. His mindset about India was a rich region.
- Hence, he came to India only to loot temples and collect the wealth for building a strong army and kingdom.
- **Alberuni (973-1048 AD):** Mahmud Gazni sent him to write a book on the Indian subcontinent.
 - 'Tahqiq-i-Hind' was the name of the book in which he described the social, political, religious, and economic conditions of then India.

The Turkish conquest of the Ganga Valley, Bihar, and Bengal (1192 and 1206)

- Between 1192 and 1206, Turkish rule was extended over the Ganga-Jamuna doab and its neighbouring area, and Bihar and Bengal were also overrun.
- In order to establish their rule in Doab Turkish rulers had first to defeat the powerful Gadhawal kingdom Kannauj.
- A hotly contested battle between Turks and Gadhawals of Kannauj was fought at Chandavar near Kannauj, in which Jaichandra (Gadhawal ruler) was defeated.
- Thus, the battle of Tarain and Chandavar laid the foundation of Turkish rule in North India.
- Aibak the slave of Muizzuddin was appointed as the governor of the acquired territories of India.

- With their base in the doab, the Turkish launched a series of raids on the neighbouring area. **Aibak defeated Bhima 2, the ruler of Gujrat and Ahilwara.**
- **Bakhtiar Khilji, an officer appointed in the East by Muizzuddin, attacked and destroyed some of the famous Buddhist monasteries of Bihar.**
- Making careful preparation, Bakhtiar Khilji marched with an army towards Nadia, the capital of the **Sena kings of Bengal. Sena king, Lakshman Sena was defeated by a surprise attack.**
- **In 1203, Muizzuddin suffered a disastrous defeat at the hands of the Kwarzmi ruler.** This defeat came as a blessing in disguise to the Turks, for they had to bid goodbye to their Central Asian ambitions and concentrate their energies exclusively on India.
- **This paved the way for the emergence after some time of a Turkish state based and exclusively in India.**

Impact of the Turkish Conquest of India

The **Turkish conquest of India** had its **impact** in various fields:

- It paved the way for the **liquidation of the multi-state system in India.**
- The political ideal of the **Turkish Sultan** was a **centralized political organization** controlled by a monarch with unlimited powers and there was no place for feudalism in it.
- The **institution of Iqtas** was employed for the purpose of breaking the feudal traditions of the various areas and for linking up the various parts of the empire to one centre
- The Turkish Sultans gave India a **Capital in the very heart of northern India.**
- They also gave her a **skeleton of an all-India administration** by bringing the chief cities and the great roads under the control of the Government of Delhi.
- The old “**caste cities**” of the Rajput period were thrown open to all types of people. The Turkish government refused to recognize caste as the basis of social demarcation or as the principle of civic life.
- There was a change in the **character and composition of the Indian Armies** and the methods of their recruitment and maintenance. The soldiers in the future came from all sources irrespective of their caste, creed, or colour.
- The **uniformity of the legal system, the tariff regulations, and the currency** widened the activities of merchants and **facilitated their movement from one place to another.**

Evaluation of the Turkish Conquest

- The **superiority of the Turks was more social and organizational.**
- **The growth of feudalism**, that is, the rise of local landed elements and chiefs had weakened the administrative structure and military organization of the Indian state.
- On the other hand, the **tribal structure of the Turks, and the growth of the Iqta and Khalisa systems enabled the Turks to maintain large standing armies** which could be kept in the field for a long time.

The **age of conflict between 1000 to 1200 A. D.** marked the churning of north Indian kingdoms. The **organizational and military might of Turkish invaders and Indian Rajputs** were put to test. This conflict eventually led to the **establishment of the Sultanates in India.** After the Mauryas and Guptas, India saw the **coming of larger empires under Islamic rulers** hence after. The cultural landscape was marked by **religious syncretism and the rise of new architectural traditions.**